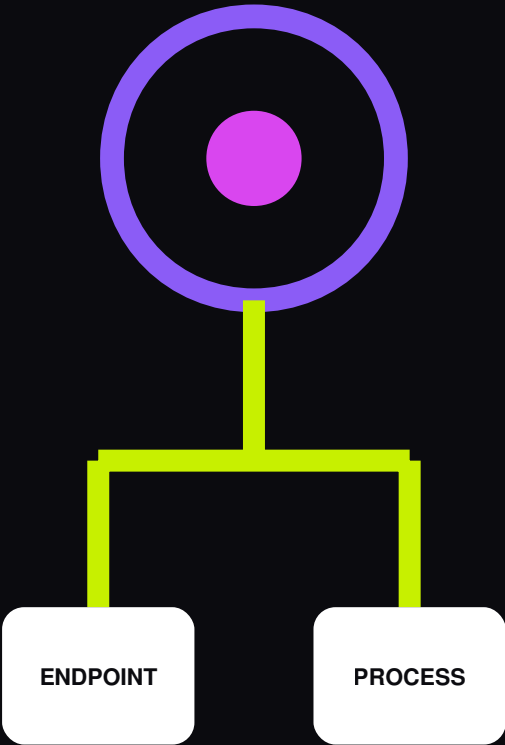


MSP360 RMM TO SILENT MSI INSTALL

Hunts for MSP360 RMM Agent launching PowerShell and for PowerShell, with MSP360 as parent, launching an MSI from Temp.

HUNTING QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



EVIDENCE BEFORE ALERTING

REPORT DATE	STATUS
30 September 2026	Untested implementation sketch
PRIMARY PLATFORM	OPERATIONAL VALUE
Microsoft Defender XDR	9.8 / 10



EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision, confidence and evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.8

Hunts for MSP360 RMM Agent launching PowerShell and for PowerShell, with MSP360 as parent, launching an MSI from Temp.

STATUS

Hunting query

Untested implementation sketch; Confidence Medium.

1primary table

0joins

0secondary rules

2validation gates

Evidence boundary

A result proves only the observed process ancestry or MSI command pattern. It does not prove phishing, a successful download, malicious ScreenConnect use, credential access, or actor attribution.



BEHAVIOR AND EVIDENCE

Observed facts separated from analytical scope.

MECHANICS

Source-supported fact

- 1 Microsoft Defender Experts observed a signed MSP360 RMM installer delivered under deceptive filenames in July 2026.
- 2 After service installation, RMM.Agent.exe launched PowerShell, which downloaded ClientSetup.msi and installed it silently with msixexec.exe.
- 3 The MSI deployed ConnectWise ScreenConnect as a second remote administration channel; ScreenConnect itself was not exploited.

Detection hypothesis

If an attacker repeats this behavior, endpoint process telemetry should expose the same source-supported process or command-line pattern. Distinction requires ownership, asset, command, and approved-change context.

Unconfirmed elements

A result proves only the observed process ancestry or MSI command pattern. It does not prove phishing, a successful download, malicious ScreenConnect use, credential access, or actor attribution.

Logic: Behavioral process ancestry **ATT&CK:** T1059.001 / T1218.007 / T1219



TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Collection prerequisites and field reliability.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint process creation telemetry with full command lines and parent/grandparent ancestry on Windows endpoints.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Approved-RMM inventory, service installation events, signer and certificate data, file/network events, service owner, and change records.

Fields	Reliability	Use
Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName	Documented	Query or triage
FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine	Documented	Query or triage
ProcessId, ProcessUniqueld	Documented	Query or triage
AccountDomain, AccountName	Documented	Query or triage
InitiatingProcessFileName, FolderPath	Documented	Query or triage
InitiatingProcessCommandLine, Id, Uniqueld	Documented	Query or triage
InitiatingProcessParentFileName, ReportId	Documented	Query or triage
Approved RMM inventory and change record	Environment-dependent	Query or triage

Excluded

No payload content, inferred execution success, actor attribution, IOC dependency, or undocumented cross-SIEM mapping is used.



PRIMARY KQL

Direct source-supported conditions with investigable output.

HUNTING

STATUS

Hunting query — Untested implementation sketch

KQL — UNTESTED

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where
  (FileName =~ "powershell.exe"
   and InitiatingProcessFileName =~ "RMM.Agent.exe")
  or
  (FileName =~ "msiexec.exe"
   and InitiatingProcessFileName =~ "powershell.exe"
   and InitiatingProcessParentFileName =~ "RMM.Agent.exe"
   and ProcessCommandLine has "\\Temp\\"
   and ProcessCommandLine has ".msi")
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, FileName,
  FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine, ProcessId,
  ProcessUniqueId, AccountDomain, AccountName,
  InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessFolderPath,
  InitiatingProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessId,
  InitiatingProcessUniqueId, InitiatingProcessParentFileName,
  ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

WINDOW

Analyst-selected;
none embedded

THRESHOLD

None

JOIN / SEQUENCE

None

SCOPE

All Defender-
onboarded
Windows endpoints



TRIAGE AND TUNING

Human validation before response.

WORKFLOW

1

Preserve

Retain the raw process event, paths, command lines, accounts, process identifiers, timestamp, and ReportId.

2

Confirm

Identify the device owner, executing account, software owner, approved automation, and matching change record.

3

Enrich

Approved-RMM inventory, service installation events, signer and certificate data, file/network events, service owner, and change records.

4

Scope

Review adjacent process, service, file, network, email-delivery, and software-deployment evidence.

Expected benign overlap

Approved MSP360 software deployment can produce the same lineage. Baseline by device, service owner, account, exact command, signer, and change record. Never allowlist MSP360, PowerShell, or msixexec globally.

Response boundary

A result proves only the observed process ancestry or MSI command pattern. It does not prove phishing, a successful download, malicious ScreenConnect use, credential access, or actor attribution.



VALIDATION GATES

Controlled tests and cross-SIEM limits.

QUALITY CONTROL

Validation steps

1. Run an authorized MSP360 software deployment and retain the raw process events for both lineage stages.
2. Confirm full command lines and stable process identifiers are populated and ancestry is correctly represented.
3. Measure representative benign volume and map recurring commands to owners and change records.
4. Review adjacent service, file, and network events without treating any single ScreenConnect domain as proof of compromise.

Decision criteria

Success: The benign test produces complete ancestry and command lines; recurring legitimate deployments are attributable and governable.

Rejection: Approved automation produces the pattern at unmanageable volume or ancestry and command-line fidelity are insufficient.

Failure: Sensor gaps, renamed agent, alternative shell, truncated ancestry, missing command line, or MSI staging outside Temp.

Platform	Decision	Missing evidence
Defender XDR	Hunting query	Endpoint baseline and validation
Splunk	No reliable implementation	Index, sourcetype, parser, sample
Chronicle	No reliable implementation	Parser and exact UDM mapping



CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

Hunting query

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A result proves only the observed process ancestry or MSI command pattern. It does not prove phishing, a successful download, malicious ScreenConnect use, credential access, or actor attribution.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1059.001 / T1218.007 / T1219

References

1. Microsoft Security Research — RMM abuse — 29 Sep 2026
2. Microsoft Learn — DeviceProcessEvents — updated 7 Aug 2026
3. MITRE ATT&CK — T1059.001, T1218.007, T1219

Document control

English dossier. No customer data. URLs are defanged in references.txt. HTML and rendering assets remain private.